



I would like to say thank you to competition hosts and Kaggle - it was a great pleasure to participate in tabular data competition after many months and years without one.

Thank you to all participants (and of course winners - [@daishu](#) huge jump during last 3 days and fantastic solo result) - our success is your success - you forced us to try harder - without all of you it would be impossible to learn so many new things and achieve such result.

And special "thank you" goes to my fantastic teammates:

- Danila
- Alexey
- Igor

No words would be enough to say how much each of you contributed to the end result.
"Do Data Scientists have hobby? Yes → DS competition".

Competition announcement

We were very hyped by the new tabular data competition release (sorry for the external link: [link](#)) and immediately decided to participate. Slack notification → rules and perspective advertisement (100% chance too lose summer holidays and all free time) → and here we are - four members. Only one member of the team had previous experience in DS competitions participation.

Few rules were established from the beginning:

- Only free time for competition
- No "second" accounts on Kaggle (even wife/friends to exclude any cheating suspicion)
- No competition discussion outside of the team
- We are here to learn and try our best

Infrastructure and pipelines:

Each of us had own machines / resources (GCP/AWS/local). We used Kaggle platform just for a few times. So the first thing we wanted to solve - unified machine to save all artefacts / experiments. We decided to go with AWS. I would say that it is possible to achieve the same result that we have just with Kaggle resources, but it would be bit more stressful for team management. We didn't want to spend a lot of money on AWS but sometimes (during very hot hours) RAM spikes were 500GB+ to permit simultaneous work.